

CRIME INVESTIGATION — EVIDENCE REPORT

Case Reference: BLR-2025-KD-0012

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1. Physical Evidence

Item E-001: Rohan's school bag recovered near colony gate bushes. Contains school books and a water bottle. No signs of struggle near the bag. Item E-002: White Maruti Ertiga (KA-05-MH-7723) recovered from Yelahanka godown premises on 5 September 2025. Vehicle reported stolen from Hebbal on 1 September 2025. Fingerprints lifted from the steering wheel, door handle, and dashboard. Item E-003: A used rope and a blindfold cloth recovered from inside the godown where Rohan was held. DNA samples collected from both items. Item E-004: A mobile phone (burner/prepaid) found discarded in a drain 200 metres from the godown. Forensics confirmed it was used to make the ransom calls. Partial fingerprint recovered from the phone's back panel.

2. CCTV and Digital Evidence

CCTV Camera PLH-04 (Colony Gate): Captures Rohan speaking with an individual near the white Ertiga at 4:10-4:13 PM. Individual is male, height approximately 5 feet 8 inches, wearing a grey shirt and dark trousers. Face partially obscured by cap. Toll booth camera on Sarjapur Road captures the white Ertiga at 4:22 PM heading towards Electronic City. Cell tower data from the burner phone confirms the caller was near Yelahanka during all three ransom calls, consistent with the godown location. Sunil Mehta's personal phone records show 14 calls to Deepak Rao's number in the 3 months before the incident, mostly unanswered — indicating ongoing tension.

3. Witness Statements

Witness 1 — Ramaiah (Colony Watchman): Saw a white Ertiga parked near the gate from approximately 3:45 PM. Noticed the driver was wearing a cap and did not make eye contact. Did not see the vehicle's number plate clearly. Witness 2 — Sunita (Neighbour): Saw Rohan talking to someone near a white car after the school bus left. Said the interaction appeared brief and the child seemed to enter the vehicle willingly — suggesting Rohan may have known the person. Witness 3 — Raju (Mehta family driver): Confirmed that Deepak Rao had visited the Mehta residence uninvited approximately 10 days before the kidnapping, was turned away at the gate, and was visibly angry when he left.

4. Forensic Findings

Fingerprints from the Ertiga steering wheel are being compared against known suspects in the database. Preliminary analysis shows the prints belong to at least two different individuals. DNA from the rope and blindfold cloth is being processed — results expected within 72 hours.

The burner phone's partial fingerprint has been sent for comparison. Call records show the burner SIM was activated on 1 September 2025 — two days before the kidnapping — suggesting premeditation.